FCC Attendance

How it works, why it was built this way, and how to fix things. A guide for whoever looks after the app. Written October 2026.

Part	Where it lives
Phone app (everyone uses this)	fcc-welcome.vercel.app/app/index.html · code: GitHub **Kellyzicoder/fcc-welcome**, folder **public/app**
Welcome form for first-timers	fcc-welcome.vercel.app · same repo, folder **app**
Send report email	Vercel route **/app-send** (folder **app/app-send**) using Brevo
Database rules	**supabase/app_setup.sql** in fcc-welcome (run in Supabase SQL Editor)
Older Streamlit site	GitHub **Kellyzicoder/fcc-attendance** (branch Kellyzicoder-patch-1)
Live database	Supabase project **fcc-church** (real people)
Test database	Supabase project **fcc-test** (made-up people, used by Vercel previews)
Hosting	Vercel project **fcc-welcome** · emails: Brevo (free, 300 a day)

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1. How a change goes live

- All changes go to the **design-preview** branch first. Never edit **main** directly.
- Vercel builds a **preview** of design-preview automatically: fcc-welcome-git-design-preview-kellyzicoders-projects.vercel.app/app/index.html. The preview uses **fcc-test**, so nothing you do there touches real data.
- When it looks right, open the pull request on GitHub and click **Merge**. Vercel updates the live app in 1–2 minutes.
- If the change touched **supabase/app_setup.sql**, copy the whole file into Supabase › SQL Editor › Run, in **fcc-church** and in **fcc-test**. It is safe to run any number of times: it only adds or updates rules and never deletes data.
- Phones may keep the old version until the app is closed fully and reopened (or refreshed twice).

Rule of thumb: merge › wait 2 minutes › re-run app_setup.sql if the pull request says so › reopen the app.

Settings that live outside the code

Where	What	Notes
Vercel › Environment Variables	NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL, NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY	Type **Config**. Production = fcc-church values; Preview = fcc-test values. These are public by design.
Vercel › Environment Variables	BREVO_API_KEY, REPORT_SENDER	Secret, server only. Needed for “Send report now”.
Supabase › Authentication › URL Configuration	Site URL and Redirect URLs	fcc-church: the live link. fcc-test: the preview link. Wrong values send sign-in links to “localhost”.
Supabase › Authentication › Emails › SMTP	Brevo SMTP (smtp-relay.brevo.com, port 587)	Set on fcc-church. Without it Supabase only sends about 2 sign-in emails an hour.
Streamlit › Secrets	database_url, logins per church, brevo keys	TOML format: each key only once per section.

2. Who sees what

Every rule below is enforced by the database itself (Row Level Security), not just hidden in the app. Even someone who opens the browser's developer tools can only load what their role allows.

Role	Sees	Can do
Admin (all churches)	Everything, every church; Admin page; database space	Everything: add churches and sign-ins, edit, delete, reports
Church admin (one church)	All people and numbers of their church	Check-in, add and edit people, assign pastors, follow-up, reports for their church, Save & lock
Team (ushers)	Their church's people for Check-in	Tick, add people at Check-in, Save & lock
Pastor	Only the people assigned to their name	Tick their own people, lock and unlock services; no adding, editing or deleting
Bishop	Numbers only for every church: dashboards, charts, calendar	WhatsApp summary and download of numbers. Never names or phone numbers.

A pastor sign-in is linked to a name on the church's Pastors list, e.g. “Lady Pastor Anna Agbenyegah”. Capitals and spaces don't matter, the title does. If a pastor sees nobody, the names don't match.

3. Design decisions (and why)

Decision	Why
Plain JavaScript app, no build tools (public/app)	Easy for anyone to read and fix; nothing to install; loads fast on old phones.
One shared Supabase database for the app and Streamlit	One source of truth; the old site keeps working while the app replaces it.
Security lives in the database (app_setup.sql)	The publishable key is public anyway; rules in the database protect data even if the app had a bug.
No real member data in GitHub	The repos are public. Names, phones and emails stay in the database only.
Free tiers only (Supabase, Vercel, Brevo)	No budget yet. Limits are listed in section 4.
Missed services count Sundays only	Midweek services are optional; coming midweek still counts as being seen.
Follow-up colours: yellow = 3–4 Sundays missed in a row, red = 5+	Simple rule leaders can explain; blue = missed only the latest service.
Visitors are never flagged for follow-up	They belong to another church or are passing through.
People not seen for 2 years move to Archive	Keeps lists and numbers honest without deleting anyone.
Ticks show instantly and save in the background	Ushers on Sunday need speed; a tick changed on another phone is never overwritten.
Edits are version-checked	If two people edit the same person at once, the second is told instead of silently overwriting.
Save & lock per service per church	Stops accidental changes after a service; anyone who checks in (and pastors) can unlock.
Everything is written to the Activity log	Who ticked, edited, locked or deleted, and when.
Phone optional at Check-in, required on the welcome form	Ushers often don't have the number yet; first-timers filling the form do.
Bishop sees numbers only	Privacy: leadership oversight without personal details.
Pastors see only their own people	Privacy between pastors; less clutter.
Church report in the church's own format, no emojis	Matches the WhatsApp template already in use.
“Open in WhatsApp” on phones only	WhatsApp Web handles shared text poorly on computers; Copy works everywhere.
Sign in by email code or password	Code needs no password to remember; password is quicker and uses no emails.
Short wording, minimal screens	Volunteers use it quickly on a Sunday morning.
Separate test database (fcc-test) for previews	Try changes without touching real people.

4. Pros and cons of this setup

Pros	Cons / limits to watch
Costs nothing to run.	Supabase free: 500 MB database (about 12 MB used in Oct 2026). Free projects **pause after a week with no use**; the live one is used weekly, fcc-test may pause (click Restore).
Works on any phone browser; can be added to the home screen.	Needs internet: no offline mode. A dead signal at church means ticks wait.
Data protected by database rules, not by the app.	Rules only change when someone re-runs app_setup.sql. Forgetting this is the most common cause of “Run the latest setup SQL” messages.
Simple code, one file for most of the app (app.js).	app.js is large (about 1,600 lines). Search for the page name (e.g. “function checkin”) to find things.
Previews use test data.	The free Supabase sign-in email allowance on fcc-test is tiny; use Password there.
Brevo sends reports and sign-in emails.	300 emails a day shared by both. Fine for now; a big church day of email-code sign-ins could reach it.
Bishop and pastors get privacy by design.	The free plan has no restorable backups you control: export CSVs regularly (section 7).
Streamlit still works alongside.	Two apps on one database: a new column must be understood by both. Keep Streamlit changes to compatibility only.

5. Common problems and how to fix them

What you see	Likely cause	Fix
“Not set up yet … isn't on the list”	That email is not in app_users of this database (live and test have separate lists).	Admin page › add the email; for fcc-test use the SQL in section 8.
“Run the latest setup SQL in Supabase”	A merge added a database change.	Copy supabase/app_setup.sql › SQL Editor › Run (fcc-church, and fcc-test).
“email rate limit exceeded”	Too many sign-in emails in an hour (worst on fcc-test, which has no Brevo SMTP).	Use the Password tab, or wait an hour, or add Brevo SMTP to that project.
Email link opens “localhost” / “Safari can't connect”	Supabase URL Configuration still on its default.	Authentication › URL Configuration: set Site URL and add the app link to Redirect URLs.
Forgot password	–	Live: sign in with Email code, then Your account › set a new password. Test: delete and re-add the user in Authentication › Users.
Pastor signs in and sees nobody	Their linked name doesn't match the Pastor column.	Admin › Change on their row › fix “Their name on the Pastors list”.
Preview shows real people	Preview environment variables point at fcc-church.	Vercel › Environment Variables: Preview values must be fcc-test's; redeploy the preview.
Vercel: “Remove the public framework prefix…”	The variable was saved as Secret.	Delete it and add it again as **Config** (keep the NEXT_PUBLIC_ name).
“Send report now” fails	BREVO_API_KEY / REPORT_SENDER missing or sender not verified in Brevo.	Add them in Vercel (Production), verify the sender in Brevo, redeploy.

What you see	Likely cause	Fix
Can't tick on Check-in	The service is locked.	Tap Unlock (admins, ushers and pastors can).
Numbers look too high or missed counts look wrong	Midweek services are recorded but only Sundays count as missed; Away/Moved people are left out.	Check the person's status and the service date; this is by design.
Someone appears twice	Added twice with different spellings.	Delete the extra one from Congregation › Edit › Delete (their ticks go with them).
Streamlit: “Invalid format: please enter valid TOML”	A key appears twice in one section, or quotes are missing.	Each name once per [section]; text in "quotes".
fcc-test stopped working after a quiet week	Free project paused.	Supabase › open fcc-test › Restore project.
App looks old after a merge	Phone still has the old page open.	Close the app fully and reopen, or refresh twice.

6. Is a public GitHub repo safe?

Short answer: nobody can change your code just because the repo is public. Public means anyone can *read* it. Only people you give write access can change it.

- **Outsiders can suggest changes** (a pull request or an issue), but nothing goes in unless you click Merge. Never merge a pull request from someone you don't know.
- **Your GitHub account is the real gate.** Turn on two-factor authentication (GitHub › Settings › Password and authentication) and keep your recovery codes safe.
- **Protect main**: GitHub › repo Settings › Branches › add a rule for main requiring a pull request before merging. This was suggested by GitHub's banner earlier.
- **Anything committed is public forever**, even if deleted later. Never commit keys, passwords or member data. Real keys live in Vercel, Supabase and Streamlit settings only.
- **The publishable key in the app is meant to be public.** Your data is protected by the database rules, which is why app_setup.sql matters.
- **Vercel** only deploys from your repo. Keep “Git Fork Protection” on (Vercel › Settings › Git) so a stranger's pull request can't use your settings.
- **Want it private?** You can make the repos private (GitHub › Settings › General › Danger Zone › Change visibility). Vercel's free plan works with private repos from your own account.

7. Out-of-the-box ideas for later

Idea	What it would give you	Effort
Monthly backup habit	Download CSVs (Congregation and Churches › Download) or Supabase › Table Editor › export, and keep them in a private Google Drive folder. The free plan has no restore button.	Small, no code
QR code self check-in	Members scan a code at the door and tick themselves; ushers just confirm.	Medium
Offline Check-in	Ticks saved on the phone and sent when the signal returns.	Medium–large
Birthday and anniversary reminders	A weekly list for pastors (needs a date of birth column and consent).	Medium
Follow-up notes	Pastors write “called, unwell” against a person; history of care.	Medium
SMS or WhatsApp reminders	Message people who missed two Sundays (paid services; consent needed).	Medium, costs money

Idea	What it would give you	Effort
Monthly trends report	Growth, retention of first-timers after 3 months, kids vs adults.	Small–medium
Home-screen app icon instructions	A Help line telling people to “Add to Home Screen” so it feels like an app.	Tiny
Privacy notice	A short note on the welcome form about how data is used and how to ask for it to be removed (NZ Privacy Act 2020, Australian Privacy Act).	Small
Uptime alert	A free monitor (e.g. UptimeRobot) emails you if the app is down.	Tiny

Privacy reminder: you hold names and phone numbers of members, including children. Only give sign-ins to people who need them, remove sign-ins when someone leaves a role, and delete a person's record if they ask.

8. Handy SQL snippets

Run in Supabase › SQL Editor. Check the project name at the top first.

Add or change a sign-in (useful for fcc-test)

```
insert into app_users (email, role, church, name)
values ('someone@example.com', 'admin', null, 'Name')
on conflict (email) do update set role = excluded.role, church = excluded.church;
```

Roles: admin, bishop (church null) · lead (church admin), team, pastor (church set). For a pastor also set **pastor** = their name on the Pastors list.

How much space is used

```
select pg_size_pretty(pg_database_size(current_database()));
```

Never run on fcc-church

supabase/test_2_sample_data.sql wipes data and adds made-up people. It is for fcc-test only.